
4.2 Assessment information

The coursework folder

Coursework folder: 2500-3000 words maximum (including quotations)

80 marks

Students will produce a coursework folder that demonstrates that the four assessment objectives have been fully met. Tasks must enable students to make informed analytical responses, showing critical awareness of the connections and comparisons between texts.

The coursework folder will consist of **either**:

- one extended study referring to all texts studied in this unit

or

- two shorter studies: if two studies are included, each must refer to more than one text studied in this unit

or

- one creative response with a commentary using the Edexcel framework (supplied in *Appendix 7*).

The creative response such as text transformation may focus on one or more texts. The commentary must include reference to the full range of texts studied in this unit. Students should be advised that the majority of the marks for this activity will be awarded for their commentary.

Whilst the element of creativity represented by their own piece of literary writing is important, the reading and research and the critical responses to their chosen reading should form the greater part of the activity and the final work presented for assessment. The weighting of the assessment objectives in the assessment criteria offer further demonstration of this requirement.

It is the centre's responsibility to inform students that there is no tolerance on the prescribed word limit. Students are required to include a cumulative word count at the bottom of each page. Teacher-assessors and moderators will discontinue marking once the prescribed word limit is reached.

Suggested areas for study

The following suggestions are provided for guidance on the types of text combinations on which tasks could be set.

One extended study

Example 1: Shakespeare's Women

Othello, Shakespeare

The Taming of the Shrew, Shakespeare

Critical comment

Example 2: Literature and Censorship

Lady Chatterley's Lover, D H Lawrence

Trial account

Media reporting

Other writers' perspectives, eg Doris Lessing on *The Satanic Verses*, Salman Rushdie

Media reporting

Example 3: Writing about Africa

The Catastrophist, Ronan Bennett

Maru or *A Question of Power*, Bessie Head

Heart of Darkness, Joseph Conrad